



Local Flood Guide

Kensington, North Melbourne & West Melbourne

Understand, prepare, and respond effectively to your flood risk.

Contents



■ Local flood information	<u>Page 3</u>
Why does our neighbourhood flood?	<u>Page 3</u>
Check your home, work, and travel routes for floodwater - Kensington and West Melbourne (Maribyrnong River catchment)	<u>Page 4</u>
What roads in Kensington and West Melbourne are likely to flood?	<u>Page 5</u>
Check your home, work, and travel routes for floodwater - Kensington & North Melbourne (Moonee Ponds catchment)	<u>Page 6</u>
What roads in North Melbourne are likely to flood?	<u>Page 7</u>
What might happen in a flood in your area?	<u>Page 7</u>
What might happen in Kensington & West Melbourne?	<u>Page 8</u>
VICSES Warnings	<u>Page 9</u>
Your local services	<u>Page 9</u>
■ Plan and prepare for floods	<u>Page 10</u>
■ What to do in a flood emergency	<u>Page 11</u>
■ Sandbag Guide	<u>Page 12</u>



Victorian State Emergency Service acknowledges Aboriginal Traditional Owners of Country throughout Victoria and pays respect to their cultures and Elders past and present.

Content reviewed: June 2026

Disclaimer: Victoria State Emergency Service assumes no responsibility or liability for any errors or omissions for any of the content in this document.

Cover photo: Kensington, 2022



For more information visit: ses.vic.gov.au/plan-and-stay-safe

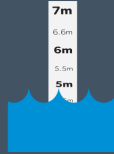


This material/publication was produced with funding provided by the Australian Government in partnership with the States and Territories under the National Partnership Agreement for Disaster Risk Reduction.

Local flood information



There have been 7 significant flood events in Kensington, North Melbourne and West Melbourne between 1998 and 2022.



The October 2022 flood caused significant disruption through Kensington, North Melbourne and West Melbourne.



Flooding can happen within hours, giving people little to no time to prepare and take action.

Why does Kensington, North Melbourne & West Melbourne flood?

This guide provides information for residents and businesses in the City of Melbourne based in areas surrounding Moonee Ponds Creek and the Maribyrnong River, which covers parts of Kensington, North Melbourne and West Melbourne.

These areas are at risk of both **riverine flooding** and **flash flooding**, which can happen separately or at the same time. Both are usually caused by heavy rainfall.

Riverine flooding

- This happens when the Maribyrnong River and Moonee Ponds Creek rises and overflows its banks.
- Water spills onto nearby land, affecting homes, roads, businesses and public spaces.
- Often caused by prolonged or intense rainfall over the catchment area.

Flash flooding

- Occurs suddenly, often with little or no warning.
- Caused by heavy rainfall overwhelming stormwater drains or falling on hard surfaces like roads.



How do floods impact communities?

Even if your home or workplace stays dry, floods can impact you in many ways.



Buildings flooded



Road closures



Drinking water supply and quality affected



Power outages



Mobile and internet network outage

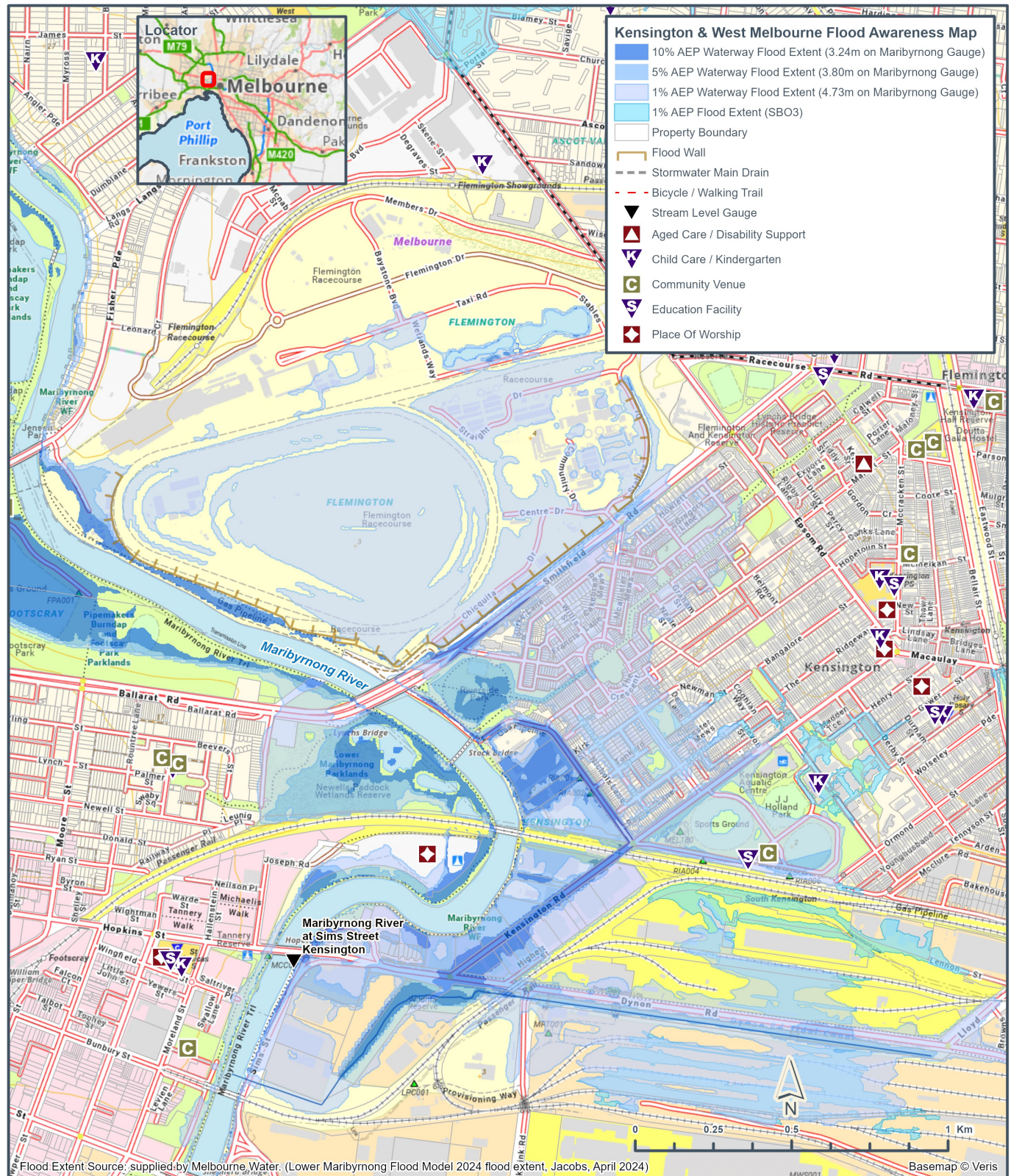


Sewage overflows inside building

Check your home, work, and travel routes for floodwater— Kensington & West Melbourne (Maribyrnong River catchment)

If this map shows potential flood risk for you, ensure you take action to **plan and prepare for floods**. See [page 11](#) for more information.

- This map shows the area likely to flood at different floodwater heights measured (in metres) at the Chifley Drive Gauge at Maribyrnong River.
- This map uses Annual Exceedance Probability (AEP) to indicate the percentage chance of a flood of this size (or greater) happening in any year.



What roads in Kensington and West Melbourne are likely to flood?

During a flood, the roads listed below are subject to flooding and could be closed.

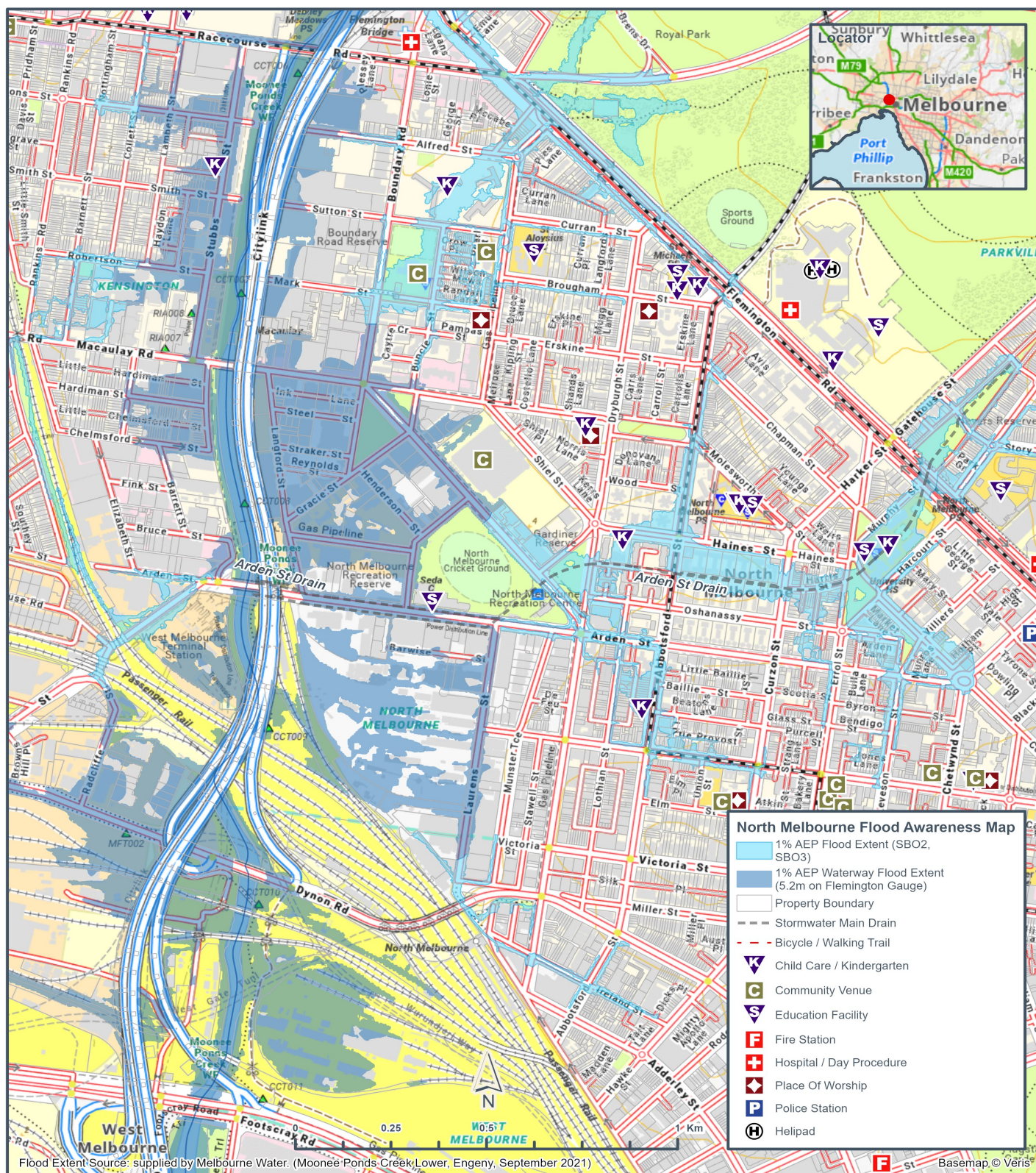
- For current road closures, check [VicTraffic](#).
- [VicEmergency](#) may include road closures in its warnings, see [page 10](#) for more information.

Kensington			
■ Albermarle Street	■ Flockhart Street	■ Lambeth Street	■ Sambell Street
■ Altona Street	■ Francis Lane	■ Lascelles Square	■ Scarborough Place
■ Balmer Street	■ Gardner Lane	■ Leicester Mews	■ Sherwin Street
■ Barnett Street	■ Gatehouse Drive	■ Little Chelmsford Street	■ Simpson Walk
■ Barrett Street	■ Graham Street	■ Little Hardiman Street	■ Sims Square
■ Bateman Road	■ Greenham Place	■ McAllister Mews	■ Smith Street
■ Bent Street	■ Gregory Lane	■ McNamara Mews	■ Smorgon Square
■ Birch Lane	■ Halford Lane	■ McTaggart Street	■ Speakmen Street
■ Bruce Street	■ Hardiman Street	■ Mercantile Parade	■ Stockmans Way
■ Cakebread Mews	■ Haydon Lane	■ Merino Mews	■ Strettle Street
■ Chelmsford Street	■ Henry Street	■ Moylan Lane	■ Stubbs Street
■ Childers Street	■ Hobsons Road	■ Musgrove Mews	■ Tankard Street
■ Clifford Terrace	■ Hodgson Lane	■ Neale Street	■ Taylor Mews
■ Colonial Place	■ Holgate Lane	■ Newman Street	■ The Crescent
■ Cornish Lane	■ Holsten Lane N	■ Newton Street	■ Thompson Street
■ Crichton Lane	■ Holsten Lane S	■ Nichols Lane	■ Wakefield Street
■ Cuffe Walk	■ Hornsby Lane	■ Parsons Street	■ Watkins Way
■ Dennys Lane	■ Howlett Street	■ Rayner Lane	■ Westbourne Road
■ Derby Street	■ Hutton Place	■ Reynolds Lane	■ Willis Street
■ Devon Street	■ Kensington Road	■ Robertson Street	■ Woodruff Street
■ Fairbairn Drive	■ Kirk Street	■ Rourke Lane	
West Melbourne			
■ Dynon Road	■ Highett Street	■ Lloyd Street	■ Radcliffe Street
■ Sims Street			

Check your home, work, and travel routes for floodwater— Kensington & North Melbourne (Moonee Ponds Creek catchment)

If this map shows potential flood risk for you, ensure you take action to **plan and prepare for floods**. See [page 11](#) for more information.

- This map shows the area likely to flood at the flood water height measured (in metres) at the Flemington Gauge at Moonee Ponds Creek.
- This map uses Annual Exceedance Probability (AEP) to indicate the 1% chance of a flood of this size (or greater) happening in any year.



What roads in North Melbourne and are likely to flood?

During a flood, the roads listed below are subject to flooding and could be closed.

- For current road closures, check [VicTraffic](#).
- [VicEmergency](#) may include road closures in its warnings, see [page 10](#) for more information.

■ Abbotsford Street	■ Dryburgh Street	■ Henderson Street	■ Market Lane
■ Alfred Street	■ Errol Street	■ Hotham Place	■ Millie Lane
■ Arden Lane	■ Falshaws Lane	■ Ink Lane	■ Murphy Street
■ Arden Street	■ Flemington Road	■ Isaacs Lane	■ O'Shanassy Street
■ Barwise Street	■ Fogarty Street	■ Langford Street	■ Plane Tree Way
■ Boundary Road	■ Gracie Street	■ Laurens Street	■ Reynolds Street
■ Buncle Street	■ Green Street	■ Leveson Street	■ Steel Street
■ Canning Street	■ Haines Street	■ Little Lothian Street North	■ Straker Street
■ Courtney Street	■ Harcourt Street	■ Macaulay Street	■ Sutton Street
■ Curzon Street	■ Harris Street	■ Mark Street	■ Vaughan Terrace

What might happen in a flood in your area?

Although no two floods are the same and the environment is constantly changing, with increased population and climate change, a greater proportion of properties are likely to be affected by flood events. The below provides an idea of what to expect for different flood sizes.



Minor impacts

- Water spilling over river banks and nearby low lying areas.
- Water coming up through drains in nearby streets.
- Water will cover minor paths, tracks, and low level bridges.
- Some backyards and buildings impacted below floor level.



Moderate impacts

- Water spilling over riverbanks and covering large areas of land.
- Water above floor level in some houses and buildings.
- Evacuation may be required in some areas.
- Impact to roads and traffic routes.



Major impacts

- Widespread flooding.
- Many houses and businesses are inundated above floor level.
- Properties and whole areas may be isolated.
- Major roads and rail routes closed.
- Many evacuations required.
- Impact to utility services (water, power, sewerage).

What might happen in a flood in Kensington & West Melbourne (Maribyrnong River Catchment)?

When the Bureau of Meteorology (BoM) issues Flood Warnings they include a prediction of the flood height at Maribyrnong Gauge at Chifley Drive, Maribyrnong. While no two floods are the same, the following table can give you an indication of what you could expect at certain flood heights, including when your access may be cut off and when your property may be affected.

- **Before a flood:** Use the floodwater heights in the table to help you decide when you will need to act to protect yourself and your property in a flood event.
- **During a flood:** When a warning is issued by [VicEmergency](#), use the predicted floodwater height and warning information to understand what the potential impacts may be for you and your community.



Height* (metres)	How likely is this flood to happen^	Properties that may flood^
4.73m	1% (or greater) chance in any year	911 properties are at risk of flooding in Kensington.
4.37m	2% (or greater) chance in any year	543 properties are at risk of flooding in Kensington.
4.22m		14th October 2022 Flood Level Peak. Three business were severely impacted in West Melbourne, five businesses had light to medium impact and there was one residential apartment block in Hobsons Road, Kensington, where the carpark flooded. This event was the third highest flood event on record for the area.
3.80m	5% (or greater) chance in any year	5 properties are at risk of flooding in Kensington.
3.24m	10%(or greater) chance in any year	5 properties are at risk of flooding in Kensington.
2.9m		Major flood level
2.44m	20%(or greater) chance in any year	
2.3m		Moderate flood level
1.7m		Minor flood level

*The height measurement is at the Maribyrnong Gauge at Chifley Drive, Maribyrnong.

^This table includes information from previous flood events

^This information is for the Maribyrnong River only—similar information is currently being prepared for Moonee Ponds Creek.

VICSES Warnings

VICSES utilises the VicEmergency app, website and hotline to distribute flood warnings and emergency information in Victoria. See [page 11](#) for more information.

You can also access this information through our social media channels and emergency broadcasters.

VICSES warnings aim to provide you with information to help you make good decisions to protect yourself and your family.

The warning level is based on severity, conditions and the likelihood of community impact.

WARNING LEVELS

	ADVICE An incident is occurring or has occurred in the area. Access information and monitor conditions.
	WATCH AND ACT (WARNING) An emergency is developing nearby. You need to take action now to protect yourself and others.
	EMERGENCY WARNING You are in imminent danger and need to take action immediately. You will be impacted.



Floodwater can be very deep, rise quickly and move fast.
Stay safe by avoiding flooded areas.



In a flood emergency, stay informed through [VicEmergency](#), see [page 10](#) for more information.

Your local services

Catchment Management Authority

For general advice about flooding and controls on planning scheme amendments.

- **Melbourne Water**
melbournewater.com.au | 13 17 22

Local Council

For relief support after a flood event and general land use planning.

- **City of Melbourne**
melbourne.vic.gov.au | 03 9658 9658.



Plan and prepare for floods

1 How to stay informed

VicEmergency is Victoria's source of emergency information and warnings.

- Set-up a watch zone for your area for alerts when warnings are issued.
- Learn about the three different warning levels.



VicEmergency app
emergency.vic.gov.au
 1800 226 226



vicemergency



@vicemergency



2 Make an Emergency Plan

Use information from your Local Flood Guide and your Catchment Management Authority, to help you decide;

- What you will do in a flood emergency
- When you will do it
- Who you will inform



Red Cross RediPlan is a free tool that helps you create a simple emergency plan that supports the flood actions you have chosen.

- Visit redcross.org.au/prepare
- Download the [Get Prepared](#) app

3 Prepare an emergency kit



Power bank



Radio



Drinking water



Spare batteries



Documents & records



First aid kit



Long life food



Torch



Gloves

Emergency kit



You may need to stay safe for 72 hours in a disaster before help arrives. Make sure you have safe drinking water, food, and any special needs or medications for all family.



There will be extra items to be added to your emergency kit in an emergency like clothes, a phone and charger.



Watch a video on how to get your Emergency kit ready.

youtu.be/XgyLnKDMkNo

4 Reduce impacts to your property

- ☐ Keep gutters and drains clear of debris including leaves and any other items.
- ☐ Check your building and contents insurance, what kind of flooding does it cover?
- ☐ Move your valuable possessions up high.
- ☐ Back up important files and documents to a cloud storage or USB kept elsewhere.
- ☐ Identify higher ground on or around your property, away from the danger area.
- ☐ Consider buying sand and sandbags ahead of time, refer to our Sandbag Guide for more information.

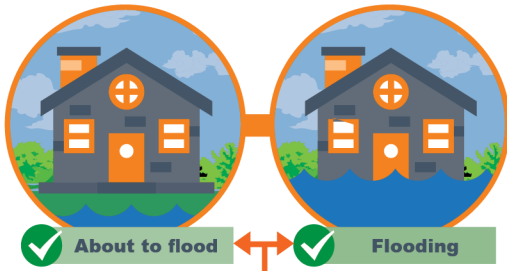


For more details and other tips, visit:
ses.vic.gov.au/flood



What to do in a flood emergency

When to call VICSES



Flood emergency assistance call VICSES 132 500



If life threatening call triple zero 000

Stay Informed

VicEmergency

Emergency warnings will provide information on what is happening and advice of what you should do.

You may not receive an official warning before a flood.



VicEmergency app
emergency.vic.gov.au
1800 226 226



vicemergency @vicemergency



■ Set-up a watch zone for alerts for your area.

Bureau of Meteorology



Monitor rainfall, river levels, weather forecasts/warnings.

bom.gov.au/vic/flood/melbourne.shtml

Emergency broadcasters



Radio | ABC 774 AM

TV | Sky News

If you expect floodwater at your property

1



Bag it

Sandbag doorways and low-lying windows to slow floodwater entering your home.

2



Block it

Block toilets, bath and drains using a sandbag ideally placed inside a plastic rubbish bag.

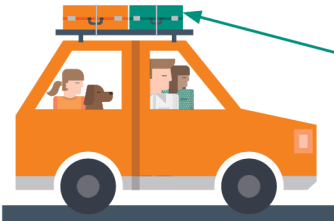
3



Lift it

Put your valuables and electrical items as high as possible. Turn off power, gas, and water at the mains.

4



Leave

- Leave **before** the flood arrives.
- Check warnings from VicEmergency for information like evacuation or relief centres, and road closures.
- Travel to the home of family or friends who are in a safe location, away from the flooded area.

Take your emergency kit and add the items below:



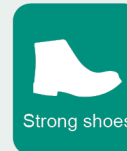
Phone & charger



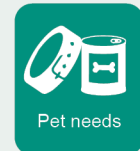
Prescriptions & medication



Clothes for your family



Strong shoes



Pet needs

Never drive through floodwater

Large



A Large 4WD can be moved by water only 45cm deep.

Small



A small car can be moved by water only 15cm deep.



For more details and other tips, visit:

ses.vic.gov.au/flood



Sandbags and sand

Preparing your home

Having sandbag supplies ready can assist you before a flooding emergency occurs.



What supplies do I need to sandbag my home?

- Sandbags
- Sand
- Plastic sheeting
- Gloves and safety goggles
- Shovel or hand scoop

Where can I purchase these supplies?

- Many sandbag supplies can be purchased from hardware stores or garden centers.
- VICSES do not routinely supply sandbags to households.
- During floods, sandbag distribution points may be established in flood-affected areas.

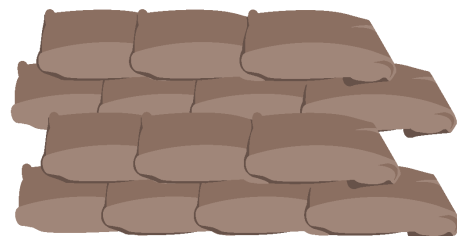


How many sandbags will I need and how much sand?

- Most homes can be protected by less than 25 sandbags.
- The number of sandbags will depend on your local flood risk and availability.
- Sandbags are filled 2/3 full which requires around 15-20kgs of sand per bag.

How do I store my sand and sandbags?

- Filled sandbags only have a short shelf life.
- It is recommended to store sandbags empty.
- Sandbags should be stored in a cool dry area away from UV light.
- Sand should be kept dry and can be stored in water-resistant containers or under a tarp.
- Sand is heavy - ensure it is stored so it can be moved safely.



When should I sandbag my home?

- **You** are best placed to decide if there is a need to sandbag your home, based on local knowledge and past flood events.
- Monitor your local conditions. Stay up-to-date with weather forecasts and warnings by downloading the **BOM Weather** and **VicEmergency** apps, or call the VicEmergency Hotline on 1800 226 226.
- If you think you are at risk, do not wait for an official warning to act.



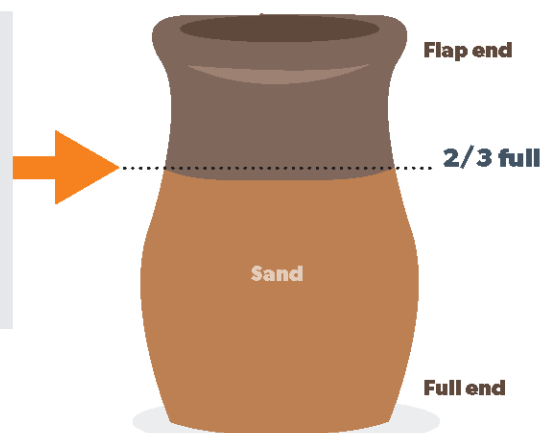
Sandbagging

Protecting your home

Sandbags won't stop the water completely, but can reduce the amount of water entering your home.

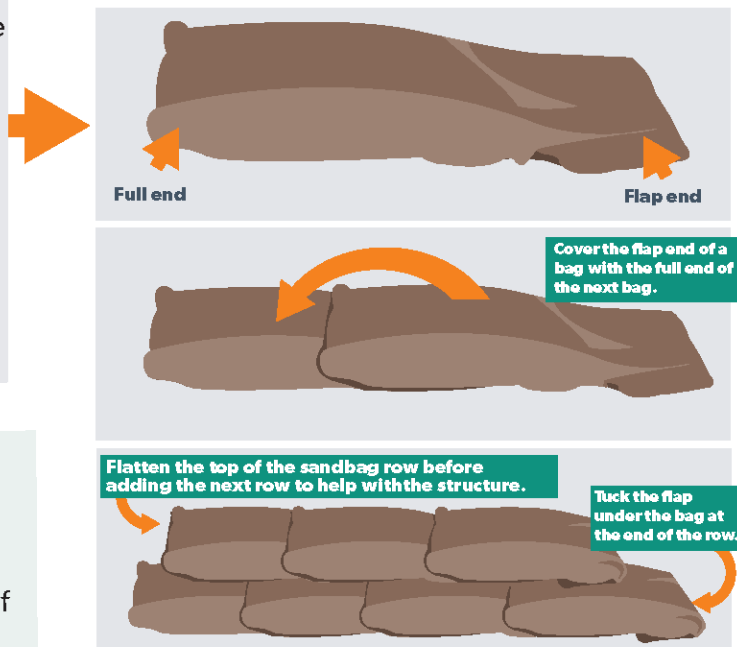
How do I fill a sandbag?

- Only use sand to fill hessian bags. Do not use dirt.
- Only fill sandbag two-thirds full.
- Do not over fill the sandbag as it will be too heavy to carry.
- Do not tie the top of the sandbag.
- Take care when filling and lifting the sandbag, to avoid injury.



How do I lay sandbags?

- Lay sandbags like brickwork. Stagger rows so that the joins do not line up.
- Start at one end and work to the other end.
- Ensure the unfilled part of the bag is covered by the next bag.
- Tuck flap under the bag at the end of the row.
- If the sandbag wall is going to be more than five (5) bags high, you will need to lay two (2) rows wide.



Where do I place the sandbags?

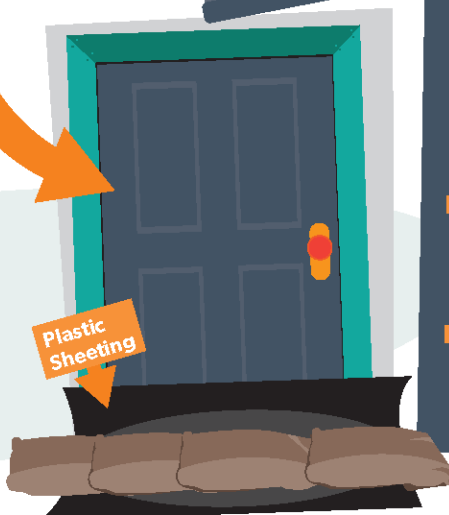
- Place sandbags in plastic bags to cover drainage holes in home (e.g. showers, toilets, sinks) to stop back flow of water.
- Place a small wall across doorways, at least the height of the expected water level. Be careful not to trap yourself inside.
- If available, plastic sheeting may be used under sandbags to reduce the seepage.

Block it

Toilets, bath and all drain holes



Plastic Sheeting



What do I do once I have finished with the sandbags?

- Sturdy gloves should be worn when handling wet sandbags as they can contain chemicals, waste and diseases.
- Sandbags that have been in contact with floodwater need to be thrown away.
- Contact your local council to find out how to dispose of your sandbags safely.

